

Interview Experience of PGDBA Batch 7

Presented By:

Alumni Cell PGDBA Batch-8

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Interview Experience & Preparation Sessions

[Session by Roushan and Shobhit](#)

[Session by Neelesh and Nitish](#)



Aryan Chitransh

First Round (Online Interview):

Questions asked to earlier candidates:

1. Number of matches in a tournament to find the winner.
2. If probability of winning match for each team and tournament structure is given then find the overall probability of a team winning the tournament.

Question to me:

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Amazon workex related questions.
3. Business case interview question: If you have the credit card data of each card user of India. How you would monetize this for Shaw.

My Approach: As the dataset is huge, going to the individual level might not be useful so, I talked with them to understand what is relevant what is not. Finalised Transaction amount, source of transaction, recurring or not, type of purchase, POS, discounted or not etc. This will me to get the type of product segment is majorly purchased or is discount strategy for visa/mastercard/rupay is working or not, POS Walmart or Amazon etc. This will help Shaw to bet on which company to grow capital. At the end you have to improve the business of Shaw, so for that understand the business of Shaw well.

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Aryan Chitransh

Cont....

Conceptual questions were asked in between the case answering. Like I said I'll be using multiple ANOVA. Follow Up questions were:

What is Multiple ANOVA. What are its components. How it is different from ANOVA. And what does each components signifies. What is AB testing and its initial hypothesis and alternate hypothesis etc.

Suggestions: Read Statistical Data Structures, Inference, Time Series, Regression and Case Studies with proper follow up questions.

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Aryan Chitransh

Second Round (Panel: Mayank and Senior Analyst Yash):

Technical Round (offline):

Explain the Project, its business implication and data source. Followed by questions on Regression, Logistic Regression, Random Forest etc. What was the Loss function, AUC ROC curve, Sensitivity, Specificity, Bias Variance tradeoff etc.

Why used Random Forest not XGBoost.

Question on Logistic Regression. Data points on given on a graph with $Y = 0$ and 1 . How will decide the threshold and cutoff to decide in which category the datapoint will lie.

Decision tree based question, what is entropy, gini index and cross entropy loss. When you will use decision tree and when Logistic Regression.

How will you contribute more to the organization comparing with the other batchmates.

Do you have question for us?

I asked will I get chance for company sponsored CFA certification.

Shambhavi Singh

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

1. Explain any 1 project in detail
2. For a energy demand forecasting problem can energy consumption be used as a feature?
3. DESIS Competition - How could the problem be solved in a better way given more time and resources

Other questions

1. Different methods to test if a regression line has fitted properly
2. How do you select/reject variables while performing regression
3. In logistic regression, how do you decide the threshold. Follow up question - Provide business use case
4. In regression, why do we square the residuals instead of using modulus?
5. Intuition behind Fourier transform on Time Series
6. Conditions for stationarity, Reason for each condition
7. Real life example of a stationary time series

Shambhavi Singh

On profile

How can data science be used in a girls volleyball team

What was the duration of your final interview?

20 min

Areas covered in the final interview?

Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company

Elaborate on your detailed final interview experience.

More of a discussion on what the role is and why this should be chosen over other consulting roles

Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

ISLR, Puzzles <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/puzzles/>

Shreya Mehrotra (*offered*)

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

Number of technical rounds - 2

- Project related : Architectures of DL models used in projects, effect of outliers on linear regression
- Analytics related : Difference between leverage point and outliers, differences between random forest, xgboost and light gbm
- Prior work ex related : Project description

Shreya Mehrotra (*offered*)

Final Round

- Areas covered : Puzzles, Subjects studied at ISI, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company
- Conceptual question on logistic regression, puzzle on KNN imputation, architecture of BERT, AR and MA terms in ARIMA model
- HR related : Interest in the firm as well as role

Preparation Resources

ISLR, case competitions

Rakshit Pande

- Two rounds -
 - 1 round - CV ques
 - 2 round - Case study - CCTV feed of parking space of a mall is given ; What can you infer from it to invest in the stocks of the brands in the mall
 - Case was very vague

Shivam Shrivastava (Financial Research Analyst, *Offered*)

•Total Rounds 2

Technical Round 1:

- Asked to explain a project of my choice.
- Asked basic questions from NLP, time series and regression concepts. Also a probability puzzle on cricket wins was also asked.
- Asked to explain the data strategies that I have used in my previous workex

Final Interview:

- Regression Assumptions and what if it Fails
- Timeseries seasonality related questions
- Error metrics used to test model performance
- Power of a statistical test and measures to increase it
- Coding question on python - Basic data analysis

Aditya Mishra (Global Analytics HR)

Technical Round 1

- Basic introduction, what exams I gave previously, and asked SQL questions related to window functions. Common SQL question asked: There are teachers in different departments. Each have a score and select top second from each department. Asked about basic python questions.

Technical Round 2:

Technical Round 3:

- Introduction and Background, asked questions on projects like what could be done differently, asked presence of minds questions like mention 30 things pencil can be used for. What initiatives you will take if you get into this role?
- Asked to exclude "not" word from stop words of NLTK.

Soumyadeep Deb (HR Analytics)

First Round (Online Interview) (With PGDBA alumni Mayank & Swagato):

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Deep learning questions.
 - Difference between LSTM and RNN.
 - Back Propagation in RNN.
 - How to prevent overfitting in a neural network.
 - Without changing learning rate, how can you prevent overfitting.
3. Discussion about the regression project and its business application. What data features we could have included and its probable impact on the model.
4. Puzzle: you have two envelopes. One have 500 rs and other amount is unknown. That could be 0 or 100 you don't know. You're allowed to pick one envelope and keep the money inside. But just before you open your chosen envelope you are given the chance to change your mind. Should you stick with the envelope you picked first or switch?

They asked if I have any question for them:

I asked what the first looks like in Shaw after joining. Swagato explained about the orientation and training program.

Soumyadeep Deb (Financial Analyst)

First Round (Online Interview) (With PGDBA alumni (Puneet, Yash) and Rohit Mehrotra):

1. Started with NLP project. What embeddings were used. What is TFIDF. Difference between Stemming & Lemmatization.
2. Yash is energy team of DE Shaw. He was more interested in my time series project. What is seasonality and cyclicity. What is stationarity and ADF test. Reason for the seasonality present in the data.
3. What is an outlier and how can you detect them.

I was offered second round in HR analytics (Human Capital).

Soumyadeep Deb (HR Analytics)

Second Round (Online Round):

Technical Round

1. Discussion started on Classification project. What is class imbalance and SMOTE & how it works.
2. Classification metrics. Use case of Precision and Recall etc.
3. One question of Python and SQL..

Soumyadeep Deb (HR Analytics)

Final Round (offline):

1. Why have you selected HR analytics. (Gave my reasoning and mentioned the HR analytics project I did)
2. Asked me to explain my project. Explained dataset and methodology used in that project.
3. Business use case of the Linear regression project.
4. Case Study: You are CEO of BlinkIt and you have stop the bleeding causing financial loss to the company.
5. What makes you not a good fit for the role.

MasterCard

AI Garage



Pelluru Manoj Sai Kumar (Offered)

Final Round (Offline Round) 40-45 Minutes:

- She asked me to explain one of the projects in the CV. I have chosen my time series project which is stock price prediction. In this project we have used few models like ARIMA, ARIMAX and LSTM to forecast.
- How do we use ACF and PACF plots to determine the AR, MA components.
- What are the exogenous variables in the problem(I said GDP could be an exogenous, which has indirect effect on stock prices).
- Why did you use LSTM(I said, the predictions based on previous models were not good, to better know the structure behind and to have better predictions I have used LSTM. Unfortunately we were not able to get the correct AR and MA components that's one of other reasons as well to have used LSTM).
- Explain the architecture of LSTM(I have drawn and explained different gates and elaborated more on how does each gate is used to know the context). I went on for about 15-18 minutes including introduction. She straight away jumped onto the projects no questions about introduction

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Pelluru Manoj Sai Kumar

Continued :

- Second project based questions are on NLP project which is a multi-class text classification.
- What is bag of words and what are the disadvantages about it. similarly what is TF-IDF and its adv and disadvantages. Essentially she was asking how did the flow happened, which is bag of words < TF-IDF < word2vec < BERT (in terms of performance). (This was for 5-6 minutes)
- Questions based on CV
What is bagging and boosting and the respective algorithms in them
What is random forest and why is it better than simple decision tree
Explain any boosting algorithm (I have explained Adaboost)
What is precision and recall, F1 score. (This was for about 8-10 minutes)

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Pelluru Manoj Sai Kumar

Continued :

- Then I was asked to go into another room where there was a guy sitting in there.
- He asked some general questions
What is regression and logistic regression and how do you explain it to a school kid and few other I don't remember them exactly, but his questions were related to company and the role offered by the company
- Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company
- Why do you think you are fit for AI Garage (I have said I am more inclined towards mathematics behind the algorithms and I think there would be more priority given to research as well for which you must have good mathematical skills and inner workings of algos).
- Do you know how mastercard works(I said I don't know)
(This was for about another 8-10 minutes)

Then again another guy came and asked few general questions in ML mostly as I have covered above and he asked how much Deep Learning you know
(This was maybe for 5 minutes)

Mangam Manoj (Offered)

Final Round (Offline Round) 15-20 Minutes:

- Started with basic ML questions such as assumptions of linear regression, ROC, classification metrics etc. and worked upto DL questions.
- In DL questions such as backward propagation, exploding, vanishing gradient problem, how to deal with overfitting in DL, asked to draw & explain LSTM.
- As I walked into the Mastercard aisle, the HR lead me to an interviewer cabin. The interviewer, who is infact our PGDBA alum, greeted and asked me to take a seat. He held my resume, glanced at the education section and exclaimed , "Oh, you have done everything!", referring to my masters(M.Tech.). Maybe he wanted to start the interview on a positive note.
- Then he glanced at the projects section, asked if any DL project (if I recall it correctly), and then started with basic ML questions and worked his way up to DL questions as I have listed. I confidently answered all the questions. Now, having gotten satisfactory responses from me, he went out and talked to the VP. Now, both of them came in. This time VP had my resume and took a final look at it. Then he shook my hand and said, "we are extending you an offer". I said, thank you and left the room, while the HR met me in the aisle and asked me earnestly if I had any other interviews lined up.

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Mangam Manoj (Offered)

Final Round (Offline Round) 15-20 Minutes:

- Just be thorough with the ML & DL basics.
- For ML- ISLR, medium articles
- For DL - IIT Kgp slide DL deck, medium articles, youtube.
- For me preparation means MAKING NOTES (on MS Onenote or some platform of your choice, preferably online as you can refer it across devices and you can keep appending notes to it anytime. Lot of flexibility.) for future reference as we tend to forget. Infact, this practice helped me greatly for the final placements. Also, do not stress yourself to make a proper/well-structured notes. Just have a broad structure & just keep copy pasting, add screenshots, and add some points here & there. That's it.

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Balraj Prajesh (Offered)

Technical Round 1 (40mins)

- Interviewer skipped the introduction and asked to explain the first academic project. Follow up questions like what is the algorithm of "MICE", what are the different imputation techniques, why did you choose "MICE".
- Interview further asked how to handle class imbalance and intuitive explanation of XGB classifier, difference between precision, recall and hyperparameter tuning done.
- Interviewer asked to explain the business project that I had mentioned, few basic questions were asked about the highlighted terms.
- From the regression project, asked about basic assumptions of regression and how to check and resolve, if any of the assumptions are violated and finally asked to explain VIF.
- From NLP project, questions were asked based on the terms highlighted in the resume such as TF-IDF etc.
- From Recommendation project discussion on overview of the data and features and asked about how the base line prediction was made, what is collaborative filtering and cosine similarity.

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Technical Round 2 (30mins)

- Asked to introduce myself, asked about my roles and responsibility as a president. There was a detailed discussion on working of Apriori algorithm.

Technical Round 3 (20mins)

- This was a HR round. Why leave the comfortable PSU job and pursue PGDBA? Asked about why I chose DNS as my first preference?

Soumydeep Deb

Interview Round :

1. Introduce yourself.
2. If some documents have gender biases and how it can be detected using machine learning. How can you remove that.
3. What is K-S test.
4. What is ADF test.
5. Explain use case of Reinforcement learning.
6. Assumptions of Linear Regression and Metrics used in classification case.

Interviewer was a graduate from IIM-L so asked her about her experience of switch to research based roles.

MasterCard D&S



Aritra Sengupta

Presentation Round

Presentation competition was floated 2-3 days before the actual interview dates. 2 topics were given and one buddy from mastercard was assigned to 4-5 students to assist them with the presentation and all. Although this had no impact on shortlisting and final selections.

Topics floated:

- Reward customers on the basis of their crypto usage.
- Customer segmentation (Merchant Segmentation for me).

Interview Round (Offline Round) 12-15 Minutes

- Introduce yourself and tell us your interests.

(Explained at the end that I was the editor in chief for PGDBA magazine AINA)

- Show us the article you wrote. Explain briefly about the article and application on this.
- Case Study: Gurugram city is too localised (IT hub and residential areas are densely localized) and major area is barren and undeveloped. Suggest an idea to evenly development of the area.
- Tell us the project which you think is very useful?
- Why this project is useful and explain some use cases!
- If you have to be relocated to Gurugram, will that be an issue for you?

Paras Atolia

Technical Round

- Discussion on one of my Classification project - Patient Survival
- What is MICE and why only this technique was used for missing data treatment
- What is recall and how this parameter is important to note in this case.
- Difference between recall/precision and accuracy.
- Questions related to Class Imbalance
- What is VIF ? What is RFE ?
- Parameters of Light GBM ?

Paras Atolia

Case Study Round

- I can see you have done graduation in Mechanical Engineering and work ex primarily in manufacturing sector. Can you think and explain some of the derived features which will help in increasing the accuracy of level gauge.
- Based on your features how can you help determine the failure beforehand using AI/ML tools ?

Questions related to POR:

- What is the current Batch Profile like?
- How can you apply ML which might help you achieve better placements.
- Basic questions on how to team is selected, why low on diversity etc.

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Paras Atolia

Suggestion

At Mastercard, you must take your case study very seriously for shortlisting in the interviews.

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Ramdasu Bhaskar

Technical Round (15-20 minutes round)

- Explain the project on CNN and how could this image processing be leveraged for company like Mastercard
- Explain Random Forest to a 10 year old child
- What is your role and what else have you participated other than your day to day job?
- It is mostly based on things mentioned on my CV and tested my communication skills
- How well I know about the role and what kind of research done prior to know the role. Tested on how much I'm interested in the role
- Why this role? How to tackle different situations and report or communicate to senior management etc

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Ramdasu Bhaskar

Suggestion

- Why this role? How to tackle different situations and report or communicate to senior management etc
- ISLR
- Just need to be cool head and communicate things clearly to your interviewer. Thought process should be clear

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Shivaang Sachdeva (Offered)

Interview Round (Offline Round) 10 Minutes:

- Introduce yourself and asked me about my workex and education.
- Asked me to describe my CV, interviews lined up and how would I react to an offer.

Suggestions:

- Everyone has similar projects, shortlisting is based on relevant work ex and standing out with some projects or Ranking/POR.
Management or corporate projects could help you stand out.
- Keep your fundamentals strong, priority companies do test this and scrutinize your data science knowledge.

Shivaang Sachdeva (Offered)

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- Everyone has similar projects, shortlisting is based on relevant work ex and standing out with some projects or Ranking/POR.
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- Keep your fundamentals strong, priority companies do test this and scrutinize your data science knowledge.

Shubham Vishwakarma (*offered*)

No technical round

Final Round

- Areas covered - Work experience/Past Education, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company, Question based on CV
- Details -
 - 2-3 mins on tell me about yourself
 - 5-7 mins on work ex
 - Share analytics perspective of your experience
 - What are the savings you mentioned in resume

Shubham Vishwakarma (*offered*)

HR Questions

Have you been to gurgaon before ? What do you like most about gurgaon ?

Preparation strategy

Put diverse projects to get shortlisted.

Try to put projects from categories like segmentation, classification, regression, time series, etc..

Tips

- Be confident in what you speak.
- Clearly communicate the idea, it's not about the language, it's about the thought, you and your interviewer are syncing or not.

Suman Raj (*offered*)

Technical Round - 1 round

- Project & Academic related : Questions related on Case competition, academic projects I did during my course, tell me about yourself, Basic ML algorithm like- Regression, Classification, Clustering.
- No questions on work ex

Final Round

- Areas covered - Projects done during PGDBA, Question based on CV, Basic ML algorithms on Regression, classification and clustering
- Final interview was more on the projects done in PGDBA and ML algorithm
- Duration - 15 mins

Preparation Strategy

Basic ML algo should be prepared, all the points written in the CV must be covered throughout. Case study also plays a vital role. Do as much case competition as you can, it will boost your confidence.

Shubham Vishwakarma (*offered*)

No technical round

Final Round

- Areas covered - Work experience/Past Education, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company, Question based on CV
- Details -
 - 2-3 mins on tell me about yourself
 - 5-7 mins on work ex
 - Share analytics perspective of your experience
 - What are the savings you mentioned in resume

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Satyaki Sinha Ray (Offered)

Total Rounds: 1

Technical Round 1: 10-15mins

- Introduce yourself.
- Why MasterCard and Why consulting?
- Asked about how the feature selection and importance was done in regression project. What business perspective was taken into account during feature selection?
- Asked about multicollinearity and R squared and R-square Adjusted.
- From classification project, what is a voting classifier? Definitions of Recall and F1 score. Asked about business impact of the project.
- Basic guesstimate: Number of bikes in New Delhi.
- Discussion on the PORs held and how it's important with the chosen role.

Aditya Mishra(Offered)

Technical Round: Around 5mins

- Asked about my approach and dataset in the Trilytics Competition, what are the things we look out while launching a pharmaceutical product.
- What is the difference between KNN and K-means? Difference between KNN and K-mediods?

Shivam Verma (Offered)

- Total Rounds: 1
- Total Duration: 40mins
- Questions were primarily from resume only. I had a number of case comp merits mentioned, so they asked some use case examples and primary analysis techniques. Some detailed questions from random forest followed as well.
- Since I have image analytics related project, there were related questions like, what is the architecture of the model used, what is GAN, adversarial learning etc.
- Few generic questions were asked like: Type 1 error, type 2 error, regression, Beta value, p value etc generic questions were asked as well.
- From the DE shaw competition mentioned in resume, there was discussion the time series concepts used in it.
- Apart from technical questions, asked about general analytics domain questions from business point of view. Location preference and Noida full form.

Samarjeet Kuila

Technical Round 1 (5-10mins)

- He asked to explain the working of K-Means clustering and logistic regression in layman terms for a 12 year old.
- Focus on the case competition they conduct.
- Asked about my experience in my previous organisations, my salary at Byjus, my JEE score etc.
- Asked me if we extend an offer will you accept it?



Parth Bhargava

Shortlisting Round

Case study was given for the shortlisting.

Case: Make a strategy for increasing the wallet loading by the customers. Ultimately leading to more engagement.

Technical Round (Offline Round) 25- 30 Minutes : Interviewer was Batch -1 Alumni

- Pick one project and explain Aim of academic project
- Project Methodology
- Feature Engineering
- Application of the project for any product and the required attributes/features will I choose for the same.
- Questions were based on project done previously in Work and I was again asked to pick the same
- Problem Definition
- Aim of the project
- Type of features used
- Best Model selection methodology (Precision, Recall, AUC)

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Parth Bhargava

HR Question

- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- Why PGDBA?

Suggestions:

- Topics covered in ISI, ISLR, Ritvik maths, StatQuest
- Prepare some projects that you can choose to confidently talk about in case asked.

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Aritra Sengupta

Shortlisting Round

Case study was given for the shortlisting.

Case: Make a strategy for increasing the wallet loading by the customers. Ultimately leading to more engagement.

Technical Round (Offline Round) 25- 30 Minutes : Interviewer was Batch -1 Alumni

- Introduce yourself.
- Explain the best project of yourself.
- Explain bias and variance tradeoff.
- Why bias creep in regression problems.
- How the flexibility of the decision boundary will affect bias and variance.
- Explanation of the regression equation and underlying assumptions.
- If all assumptions are being fulfilled only heteroscedasticity is not. How will you handle this.

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- Few points were drawn on board and was asked to identify the outlier.
- Out of boxplot or scatter plot which one you will use for the detection of outliers and why?
- Random forest was applied on one dataset without outlier detection and treatment. After this to improve the accuracy, XGBoost was applied to improve the accuracy. Where is the problem?
- (RF is not much affected by outliers as it works on sampling, while XGBoost is sequential so highly affected by presence of outliers)
- My previous domain was oil and gas. They asked why I am switching to analytics industry.
- **Interaction with Souvik Bhattacharya (Zoom call) :**
- My work ex was on the higher side compared to the batch. He asked, as many of the batchmates were younger or had zero work ex, Ever I had any ego problem with them? And How did I handle this.
- You are switching the domain completely, and past work ex will be nullified after this. So how are you planning your career.

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- Why did you select PGDBA for switching to analytics domain out of all other courses available.
- Do you have any question regarding Playgames.
- **Interaction with Playgames VP (Zoom call) :**
- Asked about Interview experience and general interaction.
- **Suggestions for Play Games:**
- Master your projects, their applicability, problem statement and steps followed.

Rakshit Pande (*offered*)

Case Study Round

- Some case study on a business problem is given
- We have to give a write up having data collection, solution approach, model, business metrics focussed, metrics to judge performance

Rounds on Final Day

- 1 or 2 technical rounds
- 1 Behavioural round and 1 HR round

Technical Rounds - 30-40 mins

- Questions from CV; Favourite project - Why you did it? Rest general session; It was like a white boarding session
- In Deep learning project CNN was asked - went in depth about - filters, size, activation function
- Classification project - metrics precision, recall, ROC were asked
- Recommender system - how will you design recommender system, collaborative filtering and matrix multiplication

Rakshit Pande (*offered*)

Behavioural Rounds - 10-15 mins

- Session with VP of Data Science
- Why you came in this field?
- What inspired you for this field? What inspired you in general?
- Research vs Practical which side excites you more? (both things work for Games)

HR Round

- No specific questions
- General talks; informal discussion

Preparation Tips

- Case round - Discuss PYQs with your friends; Discuss start to end of problem solving
- Tech - ISLR

Satyaki Sinha Ray

Online Shortlisting Round Pen paper based(Around 1.5 hours) :

- Case: Make a strategy for increasing the wallet loading by the customers. Ultimately leading to more engagement. We need to write the steps of our approach including which model we choose and feature selection etc. No need to write code.

Technical Round 1:

- Asked about my work experience and it's relevance to the analytics role being offered.
- From regression project, asked about backward selection and how's it different from forward selection. Asked to explain VIF concept and it's formula. Comparison of grid search and randomised search. Why I chose randomised search? How the feature selection was done?
- From classification, asked to define precision, recall, F1-score. How to handle class imbalance using SMOTE?
- From segmentation project, asked about RFM analysis and it's importance. Asked about elbow method and silhouette score.
- From additional project, asked about non-parametric regression and DTW distance.

Aditya Mishra

Technical Round 1

- Asked me to choose top two projects and explain them. He asked about confusion matrix, true positive rates, AUC, ROC curve. Can we have confusion matrix of more than 2×2 ? If yes, then how do we interpret the matrix?
- Most of the concepts from time series were asked such as what is lag, ACF, PACF, how will you remove outliers? etc.
- From Human activity recognition project asked about PCA, SVD and relationship between them. What is eigenvalue decomposition? What is SVM and explain about kernel trick? What is RBF?

Technical Round 2: Rapid fire round

- What is elbow point? What is ANOVA? What are clusters and how is clustering done? What is log loss? What is K-means, PCA? What is R square? Difference between random forest and XGBoost? Difference between bagging and boosting?

Soumydeep Deb

Case Study :

Improve the recommender system to the customers using different games.

First Round:

1. Tell me about yourself. (I mentioned my CAT score and chess)
2. How do you joined PGDBA.
3. Bias and Variance tradeoff
4. Time series project: Asked about seasonality, model used and FBProphet model.

Soumydeep Deb

Second Round :

1. Why do you want to join Games 24X7. what are your interest and hobbies. (It was basically a fit check question)
2. How much you'll rate yourself in python and SQL.

I focussed more on the business aspects and ideation part. Which is not a right strategy as it is purely technical company. Was not selected.



pwc

Perla Abhinay Sai (Offered)

Technical Round (Offline Round) 30 Minutes :

- Asked to explain the customer segmentation project. Some cross questions related to attributes of the data, clustering techniques used, evaluation metric used in clustering.
- Regression project: Questions on cross validation, hyper parameter tuning, regularization, R^2 vs adj R^2 .
- Case study : Formulate an end to end approach to decide pricing of a parcel to be shipped from one location to another location. Ideally we should start with data (what kind of attributes you choose) to modelling (how do you convert this to a ML problem) to evaluation (how do you interpret the results & take actions).
- Asked to rate myself on python & pyspark

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Perla Abhinay Sai

Final Round:

- Word embedding technique.
- SVM hyperparameters
- Asked about time series clustering techniques.
- SQL question related to sequential sorting
- One puzzle (i didn't remember exactly)

Suggestions:

Prepare traditional ML concepts well (& Deep learning basics) , Practice Guesstimates and case-studies among yourselves by forming groups, Practice basic SQL concepts.

Aritra Sengupta

CV Shortlisting Round :

Purely CV shortlisting and no pattern howsoever was identified.

Technical Round (Offline Round) 15-20 Minutes :

- Introduce yourself.
- Case: Mumbai to Delhi have flights and Delhi to Hyd have flights. But no direct flights available from Mumbai to Hyd. Now one airline wants to start this route and wants to know whether this will be profitable or not?. Other candidate had this case: One company wants to introduce electrical scooter in tier 2 city. Tell us approach to identify the sales and profitability.
- Asked about my role in Magazine and explain the article.

Kiran Pilli (Offered)

All rounds online

- First two rounds were technical where they asked questions on ML, DL and in-depth discussion on projects.
- The next 2 rounds based on data science case study from variable selection to deployment.

Satyaki Sinha Ray

Technical Round 1:

- Entire round was based on a consulting case study. The case was based on a common framework given in Victor Cheng.

Round 2:

- Few high level questions from regression.
- Asked briefly about projects I worked in the previous organisation, tools that I used and it's relevance to the data analytics domain.

Round 3 Personality Test:

- They asked me about my extracurriculars like what I learnt from them, what challenges I faced during my PORs and what I could have done better.

Round 4 HR

- Why consulting? How do you think your knowledge of PGDBA will help the firm?
- Overall I felt the company focus was 60% business and 40% technical.

Shivam Verma

Total Rounds: 2

- The tech based questions asked in these rounds were very similar to my interview experience with MasterCard. Also here they focused more on time series and logistic regression
- Based on my experience I feel PwC is very clear on the candidate requirements, which is strong technical plus case studies frameworks and puzzles. Not much coding though, but all theory of Deep learning and regression/classification. I didn't face much questions from random forest, but not sure about others

Lokesh Bhavsar

Total Rounds: 4

- In first round asked about machine learning techniques used in the project.
- Second and third round were case study based.
- Very senior person took the 3rd round. Asked two case studies based on the job profile applied like retail etc. (retail based case studies) and demand forecasting case studies.
- Prepare for data science case studies also product manager case studies (check with IIM C PGP). Find algorithms, features, alternate models and metrics to measure the impact.

Soumydeep Deb

Interview Round :

They majorly asked only on the deep learning part. What is deep learning, Convolution, Regularization techniques.

Some puzzles from geekforgeeks like Swapping two numbers without using third variable.

After that HR round.

Offered at the end.

ReNew
POWER

Hitesh Meena (Offered)

Technical Round (Offline Round) :

- Describe your best project. Explain what you did. Dug deep in mathematics and theory used behind the concepts used.
- Normal distribution, Probability question, guesstimates

Final Round :

- I was asked to introduce. Then he picked one of the projects that was mentioned in the CV. They were interested in Regression and classification. Every interview i was asked Assumptions of linear regression, heteroscedasticity and the impact on coefficients. Asked about class imbalance , Precision and recall, AUC ROC.

Life Is On

Schneider
 **Electric**

Samarjeet Kuila (Offered)

Technical Round 1 (Director Finance Transformation and HR) 20-25mins:

- The interviewer did not have much knowledge about Machine learning. He asked about my work ex at Byjus and how I identified the reasons for Churn (feature selection and evaluation metrics), how the features will be visualized in a dashboard. Further questions on how analytics can be used were also asked.
- Asked about what features were used for the Telecom Churn prediction project. There was very less discussion on technical part of the project.
- He asked about how comfortable I am with automation tools like python, tableau.
- He asked how to predict forex exchange dollar to rupee conversion. I told him my approach using time series methods and there was no further discussion on this.
- Finally HR took over and asked about what do you know about Schneider Electric? why do you want to join our company?

Coca-Cola

Samarjeet Kuila

Technical Round 1 (40mins):

- Started with my work experience. Asked about a popular story board I had built at Byjus (on parabola topic).
- Case Study: A company has four shampoo brands, and for the three brands sales are good but for the fourth one there is decline in sales. What is the reason for decline? This is a standard case.
- Asked about what do you know about us? I think they were expecting an in-depth answer.
- Asked to elaborate my customer segmentation project. I told them about features and had used PCA to reduce the data to 4 dimensions. There was some confusion, the interviewer thought that PCA had give four important features, so I had to get into technical details of PCA to clarify how the four principal components are a linear combination of features.



Dr.Reddy's

Nitish Kanaparthi

Technical Round 1:

- The interviewer asked to introduce myself.
- Then asked about a competition in my resume related to healthcare analytics (Trilytics case comp). I clearly elaborated the data given and the aim of the project along with our solution. He responded saying this is what you have to do in Dr Reddy's.

Round 2 and 3 (HR) with total duration of 30mins:

- Then the second round was more like team fit or HR interview. Asked how you are going to respond with someone in the shop floor if you observe anything wrong that they are doing
- Later there was an interview with other HR she also asked some basic HR related questions like are you willing to move to Hyderabad and all (the last two rounds happened for less than 30 mins)

Lokesh Bhavsar

•Total Rounds: 2

Round 1:

- First round was very normal round and the interview round was mostly based on my work experience.
- He asked me a case based on my work exp. It was inventory related.

Round 2:

- General interaction and he asked about work experience
- Why this industry? What are your plans 5 years down the line? Quite similar to providence

Lokesh Bhavsar (FedEx Interview)

Technical Round 1:

- It was a general interview about the role and then asked few questions about my favourite project. Then he asked questions on SQL as I had mentioned in the resume.
- Be very informed about the company and the role they are coming. They asked me questions on my classification project, F1-score, precision, recall AUC ROC curve, working of random forest algorithm

merilytics
AN ACCORDION COMPANY

Kiran Pilli

Round 1

- Asked about the gap and discussion on guestimate problem.

Round 2

- Optimization Problem: To maximize revenue based on few constraints such as how many units need to move from a particular location. The interviewer wanted to know what are the variables and constraints.



Kiran Pilli (*Offered*)

Total Rounds: 1

Duration: 45mins

- Data science case study end to end solution.
- Asked about gap and discussed about work experience.
- It was more of a personality test interview, where situation based questions were asked and I feel communication skills played an important role.

Shivam Verma

Total Rounds: 1

Total Duration 30 mins

- Explain any one past project? How you handled the team members, manager, various stakeholders etc. Another vague question related to some typical questionnaire of P&G (I think it is available somewhere online.. maybe in the youtube)
- Very general regression related question and few general questions based on the resume.
- Why do you want to join P&G? Why do you think we should hire you? What other companies offers do you have (I tried to Dodge this.. successfully)
- P&G specifically looked a bit new from data science point of view, I think if anyone is targeting this company, just focus on the P&G test and clarity of expression in interview



QRT

QUBE RESEARCH & TECHNOLOGIES

Kiran Pilli

Technical Round 1

- Questions on the time series case competition. Factors which affect inflation and how does RBI control it. What is the effect of repo rate on inflation?

BCG

Aryan Chitransh

Technical Test (HackerRank Platform) :

Data transformation related test in python. Asked to apply Xgboost on given dataset for classification problem.

Pre Placement Talk at Taj Bengal (Alumni: Saurav Rajput):

You will be judged there as well. So you have to interact with each partner, know about their experience, success stories. Behavioural aspects, extra curricular and interests will be discussed.

Aryan Chitransh

Technical Round Interview :

A case was given that I'm not able to recall. He asked me about how will I do the feature engineering, loss functions and model to be used etc.

I had a project on Credit card fraud detection. What are the type of credit card frauds.

Understand the business aspects of your project and its implications & benefits to the firm.

Suggestions: At each interview you have to perform atleast above average. As any day can be your bad day but your bad day performance shouldn't be lower than the BCG standards.

Aryan Chitransh

Business Case Interview:

Introduce yourself.

Case1: Suppose you are working in a mining company and while mining you find that some rare earth metal is identified which is very crucial for battery technology. Define a strategy to make that mining profitable.

Case2: Ecommerce related.

As due to the covid majority of the people are in WFH mode. Amazon warehouse are designed as per the demand of that city which they will cater. Due to covid, deliveries are delayed and customer dissatisfaction has increased. Give recommendations for the business improvement.

Suggestions: Understand the algorithms thoroughly and business part of each project you have done.

Shambhavi Singh

How many technical rounds were there? (Before final interview): 3

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview):

Following was the sequence of rounds followed before the final interview -

Round 1 - CV Shortlisting

Round 2 - Test

Round 3 - Technical

Round 4 - Technical

Project/Competition based questions (Round 3,4):

1. Describe any one project in detail
2. How were external features chosen? Any other additional feature which you would want to consider?

Describe briefly questions asked tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview):

1. How's gradient boosting different from other boosting algorithms?
2. What are the hyperparameters for gradient boosting algorithm?
3. If log features are considered, how would the output variable change? What's the incremental change in output variable?
4. If each variable is increased/decreased by x amount, how would the coefficients of regression equation change?
5. How to handle categorical variables while using clustering algorithm?

Profile Related Question:

1. Have you used any data science algorithms during your tenure at Airtel?
2. Now that you have gone through this course, how would you apply any 2 algorithms in telecom industry, giving the business impact

Duration of interview:

2 round of 30 mins each

Areas covered in the final interview?

Work experience/Past Education, Case study

Elaborate on your detailed final interview experience.

2 case rounds with leadership team

Case 1 - If a telecom company ties up with some 3rd party OTT platform, how would it target its customers to take up this plan and what should the price point be

Case 2 - While building a churn model for telecom, the customers churning out wasn't found to be correct. The model is well built and all pipelines have been properly defined. What could be the reason for this?

Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

ISLR, IIM A/B/C Casebook

Any other tips you would like to share?

Be thorough with python/R for coding test round. Maximum eliminations happen in this round.

Varshit Dubey

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

Questions on projects, what more can be done to improve mape, what features were important, what parameters you took to build the model?

Coding test - pandas skills, joins, groupby, aggregation, modelling code.

Questions on xgboost what parameters are there in xgboost, bias variance trade off in xgboost parameter, sarimax and data science case studies.

What software did you work on, future/options basics since my past company work was in futures and options.

Areas covered in the final interview?

Case study, Guesstimates, Puzzles, Subjects studied at ISI, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company

Elaborate on your detailed final interview experience.

3 cases were asked in 3 rounds at bcg.

In de shaw it was company specific question, a question on write sql query, a question on Elbow in kmeans.

Mention any HR questions that were asked.

NA maybe in de shaw at end it was company specific questions like which team did I like the most (since I was aware of their different business verticals)

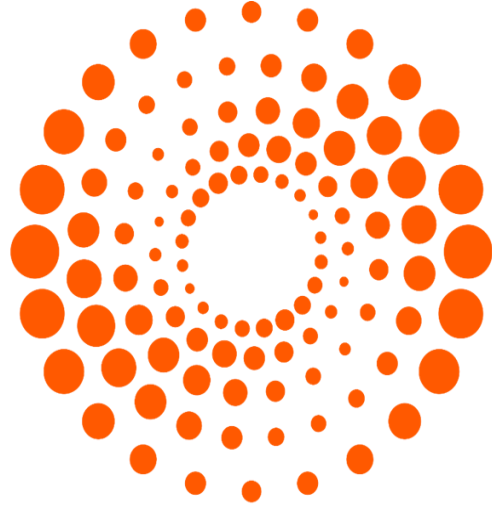
Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

Case study iim abc, data science case studies (google is best resource), I had a ML research paper, past research internship and past academics which helped me in shortlist and boosted my profile.

Rakshit Pande

2 rounds were taken other than coding round before final day

- Round 1 - More towards CV; Project specific technical questions
- Round 2 - Case study - How would you target people to offer increase in the credit limit? What data is needed and how to identify such people?



THOMSON REUTERS

Shubham Mulay

Analytics related questions :

- 1.Explain this concept or algorithm (GridSearch, F1-score, etc), why this was used. Cover all the technical concepts in your CV.
- 2.Prepare for probability/ PnC based questions.
- 3.Basic coding questions.
- 4.One of the company (TR labs) took a test before the interview, with MCQ (negative marking) and coding question on puzzle or dataframe (pandas based). Be hands on pandas, SQL if you can.

Projects related questions:

It started with the description of the project. Then follow up questions on what technique was used and why ?

Suggestion: Prepare a short pitch for all project and use the project which might be more relevant to the company. Be ready for any follow-up questions

Parag Aggarwal

Technical Round

- Brief introduction
- What courses studied in PGDBA
- Basic ML definitions.
- Time series forecasting project: how I proceeded with forecasting
- Discussed about the products company provides.
- Just know everything written in the CV.
- All the basic definitions of ML should be on the tips. Most of the companies ask this.
- Topics: Regression & Classification projects
- AUC, ROC and other metrics related questions

Continued on next slide...

Abhinav Ayush

No. of interview rounds: 1

Duration: 40min

Areas covered in the final interview?

Projects done during PGDBA, Subjects studied at IIT, Question based on CV

Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

learn complete theory of classical ML and basics of deep learning

Elaborate on your detailed final interview experience.

"Project based TF-IDF, XGBoost algorithm and what are its hyperparameters to reduce overfitting, then What is Random Forest what is difference between Bagging and random forest?"

not project based Interviewer asked about word2vec, RNN, LSTM basics

There was a 20 min test in the interview where questions were multiple choice type, you have to manually mark in front of interviewer.

Questions were related to completely conceptual related to classical ML, like Linear regression, Decision tree, Multicollinearity, cross validation, How will you handle multicollinearity if two correlated features are critical, L1 & L2 regularization, why do you want to do cross validation? Options will be there

Then two coding questions will be there

You have to choose between pandas based data manipulation

And normal problem solving based on list dict

You can choose one between two

Nitish Kanaparthi

Technical Round 1:

- Interviewer asked to summarize the project on Topic Modelling (Unsupervised modelling) as the company was also working on a similar project as part of text analytics.
- The follow up questions were what is NMF (Non Negative matrix Factorization) and what is Latent Dirichlet Allocation(LDA)? Why did you use only these particular models? Also asked basic questions on the metrics used.

Final Interview (40mins):

- Interview started with my introduction, then the interviewer asked about the project on Topic Modelling which they are currently working on (explained the same and he was good about that).
- Then he gave me a case study about call centre (utilization of call centre audio files) like how to leverage the audio transcript data to make business decisions. I came up with a couple of attributes which can be derived from them and explained him how a complete pipeline could be built. Then he asked about my PowerBI skills and to rate my skills in PowerBI from 0-10. Asked about cloud experience.
- TR mostly works on Media analytics which uses more text analytics and time series forecasting. So brush up deep learning techniques and forecasting part. Along with that there is a major use of PowerBI (dashboarding) and cloud(AWS). So any certifications related to cloud could be of great advantage.
- **Tips:** Cloud certification and dashboarding skills are important.

Satyaki Sinha Ray

Total Rounds:1 (AI Labs)

- It was a coding+MCQ round, where I had to share screen to the interviewer while answering. Mostly ML related tech questions were asked in the MCQ section. For the coding part, we had to write only part of the code.
- Once I was done with the coding part, he asked about NLP based questions like stemming, lemmatization. How does TF-IDF work? Basic questions on transformers and one question on basic working principles of CNN.



Vaishnav

Technical Round

- Basic statistics(most of questions) and asked about some projects in cv
- Make a clear understanding of topics that were taught to you.

HR Round

- Tell about your family and what is the most exaggerated point in your CV
- Asked about why analytics, why product company and some HR questions

Continued on next slide...

Vaishnav

Suggestion

- Revise everything in systematic way
- Take help of your friends and prepare together, have different point of views with you and add your point of view to others, this is most important at the end We are not competing with our peers, we are competing with other college students and Market



Providence

Zuha Kardar

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

Was asked to explain a clustering project

Basics sql related questions on joins. Basics of python and linear regression, classification

Duration :1 hour

Round: 1

Areas covered in the final interview?

Work experience/Past Education, Projects done during PGDBA, Past Projects, Case study, Guesstimates, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company

Elaborate on your detailed final interview experience.

Was asked a guesstimate to estimate the number of biryanis a software developer living in Tier 2 city would consume in a year. And eventually spend on that consumption.

Questions about my past work ex and in general about hobbies.

They were keen on testing communication skills in this round.

Mention any HR questions that were asked.

Why Providence?

Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

Cover all the basic algorithms in your resume. And all fields like finance, marketing, operations, healthcare, etc

Prepare your projects thoroughly and the why of every algorithm you used.

Prepare case studies and guesstimates and work on your communication skills.

Be clear in your thought process.

Mayank Ray Mishra (*offered*)

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

- No questions were asked from project/competition
- Round 1:
 - Questions around statistics & probability : random variable basics, distributions & their applications, hypothesis testing (basics), Bayes theorem and applications , questions around ANOVA
 - Questions around ML: Bagging & boosting(what happens under the hood & differences)
Metrics & their differences(Precision, Recall, F1, Recall)
 - Questions around DL(Basics of BERT & its architecture)

Mayank Ray Mishra (*offered*)

Continued

- Round 2:
 - This was more of a consulting round and was very spontaneous round. I was given a very random case study and asked to solve it, I was given 20-25 mins for it, and it was more about asking the right questions related to the case and was I able to come up with a final number.
 - I was then asked what were the reasons behind joining a healthcare firm , and any answer that I would give were followed by either more questions towards my aspirations or was told that this may not be achievable. Bottom-line, this round was more about how i could articulate my thoughts and stay consistent throughout the interview.
 - **Work ex** - Was asked to describe the projects written in resume & tech stacks that I had worked on. Was also asked to describe any challenges that were faced & how I navigated through it

Mayank Ray Mishra (*offered*)

Areas covered in final round

- Work experience/Past Education, Case study, Guesstimates, Subjects studied at ISI, Subjects studied at IIM, Subjects studied at IIT, General Awareness, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company
- HR Round :
 - Why do you feel that you are best suited for this role?
 - What are the qualities that best define you
 - What are your professional goals that you would try to achieve by being a part of this firm
 - What makes you different from the other candidates we are interviewing

Mayank Ray Mishra (*offered*)

Kindly share preparation strategy, material, topics etc. you feel is helpful.

- No GD involved
- Resume shortlisting is black box - Since PGDBA doesn't suddenly make you a 10 + yrs experienced Data Scientist, most of the projects in everybody's resume is nearly the same. What matters is how you are able to formulate problem statement effectively, identify the problem that you were trying to solve, provide baseline solution and how you improved upon that & what was the business impact of your solution. Carefully articulating the words becomes important as it could be the HR/ technical person looking at the resume and that resume is the only means to judge a candidate at that moment.
- Make sure if you have a target company which you are strongly feel aligned to (in terms of your professional aspirations), some project which can relate to what the company does can help you guide the interview in your favor. I did this by putting a healthcare domain additional project and project in work-ex related to Pharma domain.

Nisar Ahmed (*offered*)

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

Just 1 technical round

- Analytics related -
 - Probability, Statistics and Inference based questions.
 - Simple questions on probability.
 - Distributions (normal and binomial)
 - Flipping of coins example
- Work ex not asked; Project related questions were asked in managerial round

Nisar Ahmed (*offered*)

HR & Managerial Round

- Duration : 10-15 mins
- Areas covered - Work experience/Past Education, Projects done during PGDBA, Past Projects, Subjects studied at ISI, Subjects studied at IIT, Question based on CV
- Managerial Round: Projects done. Courses in IIT
 - Interviewer picked few projects and asked to explain those.
 - How was the dataset obtained?
 - What was the approach?
 - Why were specific models used?
 - Metrics used
- HR Round: Asked about past experience.

Nisar Ahmed (*offered*)

- HR Round questions :
 - Tell me about yourself.
 - Why Providence?
 - What were the projects you have done in the course?
 - Explain the most interesting project you have done.
 - Why do you want to work in Healthcare industry?
 - What are the values of Providence?
 - Can you explain me your role in the previous company.
 - How did you show entrepreneurial spirit in your previous company?
 - Why do you not want to go back to your previous company?

Nisar Ahmed (*offered*)

Preparation Tips

- Don't ignore the basics. Even simple statistics questions are asked in the interviews.
- Do projects applying the most recent models. Currently Deep Learning is in trend and most companies expect you to know at least the basics of the most recent models like transformers, BERT, GPT etc.
- Use Deep learning in your projects and be thorough in the models used

Resources

- Statquest videos and book
- ISLR
- Important ML/DL questions for interviews.

Kiran Pilli (Offered)

Total Rounds: 2

Technical Round 1 (30mins)

- Rapid fire round of short answer questions based on keywords highlighted in resume, ML, word embedding and probability distributions, CDF.
- Why choose one algorithm over another in the projects?

Technical Round 2

- Health care related case study. From feature extraction to deployment. While solving take ethics and privacy into consideration as all the features may not be used and inform the same to the interviewer.
- Questions were asked from linear algebra and about LightGBM versus XG Boost.
- Why healthcare? Why Providence?. I did detailed research about the company which helped and I was genuinely interested in healthcare because of the humanitarian aspect, moreover Providence being a not for profit organization, the work will be concentrated on the company goal, instead of just focusing on revenues.

Technical Round 3

1. Again drilled on Why healthcare? Why Providence?

Lokesh Bhavsar (Offered)

- Total Rounds: 3

Technical Round 1 (Senior Project Manager) 45-50mins:

- Introduce yourself, asked about what I learnt from the programme. Then asked about demand forecasting from WorkEx and overall profile, roles and responsibilities at Accenture.
- General questions about course like mention two favourite subjects, what else did you learn apart from technical things?
- Asked questions from NLP project, sentiment analysis, from business perspective. Follow up questions like what is word-to-vec and the business impact of R^2 value. What was the business problem? How did you convert it into data problem? For every project you need to have some interesting challenge.
- I was asked on all the four projects, not very deep questions. I had to portray the business application of the project. The interviewer was not very technical person.
- The interviewer was interested in stories of the projects like what's the business problem and how did you convert it as data problem, what's the interesting part of the project? for every project motivation behind choosing the project. If you find the problem statement interesting then you need to be very clear on what interests you? Depending on company to company these questions may or may not be asked.

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- Why do you want to join health care industry? Not just focus on tech things.
- Be thoroughly prepared for the common 10-15 HR questions for all the companies.
- Why this sector? We need to show ourselves that we are culturally fit for the company and be clear with our motivations for health care.
- My response was I have seen initiatives of Delhi govt in education sector. Education and health care are the two sectors to transform the society as these are part of the Maslow's five fundamental human needs also Providence is a not for profit organization. If counter questions asked then try to answer based on the fundamental aspect of healthcare.

Technical Round 2 (Director of Data Science) 50 mins:

For the first 10mins the director introduced and talked about the company, culture etc

Majority of the questions were asked from NLP and customer analytics project. Questions similar to 1st round were asked. Questions from MLR and Decision Trees were also asked.

Technical Round 3 (35-40 mins):

My prior work experience had been in Accenture and the interviewer was also from Accenture. He asked me if given an option do you want to join Accenture? Be careful not to talk bad about the previous company. I responded by saying as the Accenture is not coming for internships, I cannot join, but I had liked working in Accenture.

He asked about the verification process of the projects mentioned in the resume.

Soumydeep Deb

Interview Round :

They were majorly asking statistical concepts.

1. Explain hypothesis testing and null & alternate hypothesis.
2. What is central limit theorem.
3. What is p-value.

Asked interviewer how they use these statistical concepts in their problems.

After this round Shaw was confirmed and I opted out from the drive.

Samarjeet Kuila

Technical Round

- Asked to introduce myself
- It was quite technical. Didn't ask anything about case competitions, over all the questions were from all the projects mentioned. Whatever keyword was highlighted in the projects, there was a very detailed discussion about it.
- Few of the questions I remember are: How did you verify linear regression assumptions? Difference between ridge and lasso? What is random forest? Why did you use it? What is F1 score and why do we use it? What is SMOTE and any other technique? What is p-value?
- How effectively we are able to communicate and build conversation with the interviewer matters a lot.



Mayank Ray Mishra

> 2 hrs of interviews

Technical rounds were final rounds

Describe briefly questions asked/skills tested in technical rounds? (Before final interview)

- The interview was heavily focused around Deep Learning projects. I had BERT projects on my resume.
- I was asked about tokenization in BERT, explain how a word piece tokenizer works (on paper). What are the other kinds of tokenizer that can be used?
- How can you get output from all 12 hidden states(encoders) ?
- Questions around architecture of BERT. Follow-up questions on that. How do you train a BERT for a Question Answering task? Explain the steps involved

Continued ..

- The 1st round of technical interview involved a live coding round where a editor was shared with me and I was given 20-25 mins to write a logical piece of code. The question was of medium difficulty, and would have required prior practice to be able to crack it during that time. It was mostly the application of python data structures
- Since I did a DL project during my work-ex, I was asked to describe the problem statement. Questions were asked around the baseline results , and what was done to improve upon that
- Challenges that we faced working with unlabeled data, and how we worked around that. Some more questions on the architecture of the solution that we built, and any resource / compute constraint that we faced. The expectation was the scale of data was huge and he wanted to know how we navigated around those challenges
- Areas Covered - Work experience/Past Education, Projects done during PGDBA, Past Projects, Subjects studied at IIT, ML/AI related questions not taught in the course, Questions pertaining to the company/industry or role offered by the company, Question based on CV

Mayank Ray Mishra

Preparation resources -

Deep Learning - Mitesh Kapra, Slides from classroom sessions

Attending KGP deep learning classes is a must

ACT Fibernet

Finals Interview
Experience



Soumyadeep Deb

Interview:

Introduce yourself.

Asked basics from projects as they were trying to understand and their business use cases.

Some questions on workex

Why not MBA after CAT, and why PGDBA

Oliver Wymen

Finals Interview
Experience



OLIVER
WYMAN

Soumyadeep Deb

Case Study Round:

They gave a problem of forecasting using XGboost on which we had to code and make a deck for presentation. Which was judged on various parameters such as EDA, Code quality etc.

First Round:

1. Introduce yourself.
2. Why PPO was awarded from DE Shaw.
3. Discussed about the project I did at my intern.
4. What is the difference between Linear Regression and Logistic Regression.
5. Why linear regression cant be used for the classification purpose.
6. In tree based methods what are node splitting criteria.

Second Round (Anshul Verma):

1. Asked probability question to find the probability of a team winning the tournament given all probabilities.
2. Asked the interviewer why OW is looking for expansion in India.

Partner Interaction Round:

This was basically the formality type round as the above two rounds were important.

What was the challenging scenarios I faced during my workex.

How many zeroes are they are in 750!

Aritra Sengupta

Overall Suggestions:

- In every interview you can expect one question regarding the projects you have done. It could be in the form of, which one is your project or in which project you are more confident or which project have wider applicability or which one is more useful. Prepare this thoroughly.
- If you want go for consulting roles then case solving and guesstimates are required as problem solving is majorly required there. For eg. Mumbai to Delhi have direct flight. If new route Mumbai to Lucknow, then Lucknow to Delhi is added. Evaluate whether new route will be profitable or not. Number of cycles in a city etc.
- PlayGames questions are very basic but conceptual. Understand the concepts thoroughly.
- Resource for case studies: Go through Guesstimates booklets from IIM A, B & C and YouTube.
- If you had any POR then questions about role, challenges and how do you tackled them can be asked. Prepare them as well.

Shubham Mulay

Overall Experience:

- Case study - Business Problem may be given and you'll be asked to provide data based solution. ex - How will you detect ATM transaction fraud.? follow up questions might be - which feature you will be used in your data? What performance metric will you use? why?
- Prepare for data science case studies as they might be asked as first rounds and you'll get shortlisted if you do well.
- Guesstimates - some of the guesstimates asked during PWS rounds -
- How many no. of people may be wearing Green colored cloths in San-Francisco on a particular weekday?
- Guess no of orders received by zomato on Valentines Day in Pune city
- Here also your logical reasoning and approach is more important than the actual answer. You don't need to remember population of every city but make your you know important ones and your Hometown/ state. Some interviewers may be satisfied with your approach alone. Some'd actually asked to calculate and give a final number.

Balraj Prajesh

Overall Suggestions:

- The interview panellist can be from senior management and at times they might not be very interested in the nitty gritty of data science concepts.
- **Be very thorough** with assumptions of Linear Regression, how to check and fix them if violated.
- **Go through ISLR end-to-end.**

Kiran Pilli

Overall Suggestions:

- Intuition based approach worked for me for the case studies asked. Form a group of 3-5 and discuss intuitively what's the logical solution like what features make sense etc.
- Intuition based understanding from StatQuest. For DL Prof Sudeshna Sarkar slides were helpful.
- Say no during interview if not sure rather than beat around the bush.
- All the probability distributions we need to know thoroughly.

Satyaki Sinha Ray

Overall Suggestions:

- For interview preparation, I studied mostly from ISLR and class notes. I also referred ISLR explanation videos in YouTube.
- For case study preparation I referred Viktor Cheng and IIM A casebook.

Aditya Mishra

Overall Suggestions:

- For Inference I referred: [PennState Inference](#)
- For ML I referred [CMU lectures](#) and ISLR.
- For last minute revision I referred, [Bijen Patel blog](#) ISLR summary.
- Take a extensive cheat sheet of SQL and start solving questions from [Hackerrank](#) These days not much theory of SQL is asked. Focus more on partition by rank and window functions. SQL maybe asked in the initial shortlist rounds.
- Learn the difference between different ML models and when to use which model.
- For timeseries I recommend going through Buddhanand sir notes and notes referred by Samarjit sir, with focus only on the results and how it can be interpreted for a given context say financial time series data.
- Few other resources which I recommend are [Jermy Jordan](#), [Zed Statistics](#)

Lokesh Bhavsar

•Overall Suggestions:

- I have built a questionnaire structure in excel as mentioned below for every project that I have done.
 1. Scenario and business problem of the project
 2. What's the goal?
 3. Data source?
 4. Data description and features
 5. Flow of the project from feature selection to model building to results and conclusions.
- Based on whichever company you are targeting.. you need to develop interest or show yourself. Why you are interested say for example gaming industry? Try answering it from past experience. Be prepared with 2-3 domains so that many companies are covered.
- Go to companies website note their taglines and cultural values.
- If not unplaced during first day.. Don't give up. Stay focused. The interviewer coming next day, do not know what has happened with you in 1st day. All they know is who you are in the present moment.
- Showcase yourself as someone who is looking for long time commitment and who is fit for their cultural values and has the technical acumen. They also check if you will be loyal to the company.